Back to Paper

Students complete a traditional paper-based MCQ test under invigilated conditions.

How It Works

- Students sit a timed on-campus assessment without access to phones, laptops, notes, or other resources.
- Multiple versions of the paper can be created by changing question and answer-option order.
- Answer sheets are marked manually or processed using optical mark recognition.
- Online quizzes may support practice, but the paper test determines the summative mark.

Shared Assumptions

- The assessment strategy must be used with more than 500 students.
- The MCQ assessment contributes 40% of the final mark for a 15-credit module.
- Assume that any proposed approach is technically possible. Focus on whether it is educationally desirable and defensible in practice.

Round 1: Develop Your Pitch

You have five minutes to prepare a one-minute pitch explaining why this approach should be adopted.

Pitch notes

Evaluate: Back to Paper

Score each criterion from 1 to 5. Scale definitions: 1 = very weak, 2 = weak, 3 = mixed, 4 = strong, 5 = very strong. Total possible score: 25.

Criterion	Key question	1	2	3	4	5
Learning value	Does it encourage meaningful learning?					
Validity	Does the mark provide credible evidence of understanding?					
Fairness	Is it equitable and inclusive?					
AI resilience	Does it remain credible when students can use AI?					
Practicality	Is it manageable for more than 500 students?					

Total score: ________ / 25

Strongest feature

Biggest weakness

Round 2: Anti-Pitch Notes

Sketch out why this approach should not be adopted without modification.

Anti-pitch notes

Round 3: Rebuttal Notes

Sketch out your response to the anti-pitch and defend the scenario.

Rebuttal notes

Detect and Deter

Students complete an online MCQ assessment, with safeguards used to discourage inappropriate use of AI.

How It Works

- Students complete a timed online assessment with randomised questions and answer options.
- Strict time limits and clear academic-integrity guidance act as deterrents.
- Activity logs are reviewed for unusual patterns, such as very rapid completion or repeated navigation away from the page.
- Suspicious cases may trigger a follow-up discussion, an additional task, or an academic-integrity investigation.

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Rebuttal notes

Open-Book by Design

Students may use AI and other resources, but questions are designed to reward application and critical judgement.

How It Works

- Students may use notes, textbooks, websites, and generative AI tools during the assessment.
- Questions focus on unfamiliar cases, interpretation, evaluation, and decision-making.
- Students may be asked to critique an AI-generated answer or choose between several plausible explanations.
- MCQs can be combined with short justifications, confidence ratings, or follow-up questions.

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Practice, Track, Validate

Students build a record of performance through regular practice, which is confirmed through a short invigilated validation exercise.

How It Works

- Students build their mark through regular low-stakes MCQ practice across the module, using dynamically generated questions or a large question bank.
- Practice is assessed in fixed two-week periods, combining accuracy, topic coverage, and completion of a capped question target to reward sustained engagement.
- The practice record contributes 70% of the final mark, with a short invigilated validation exercise worth 30%, completed through designated bookable slots in a small computer room.
- The practice score cannot exceed the validation score by more than 20 percentage points. Students who achieve at least 40% in validation cannot fail solely because of limited engagement, but they cannot earn a strong grade without sustained practice.

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Rebuttal notes

Reward the Work

Students earn marks through sustained MCQ practice, with regular limits used to reward consistent engagement rather than last-minute activity. There is no end-of-module assessment for this MCQ component.

How It Works

- The module is divided into weekly or fortnightly windows, each with a fixed amount of credit available.
- Students earn marks for correctly answering a defined number of questions within each window.
- Credit is capped by topic or learning objective to encourage breadth and prevent easy-question farming.
- A limited number of missed windows can be discounted or recovered to account for short-term disruption.
- There is no final end-of-module MCQ test; the mark is built from performance across the scheduled practice windows.

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